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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

Italy is well known for its wine and as a student born and raised here I was particularly interested in the making of wine therefore I started looking at the fermentation of wine. I was initially considering writing about the difference between fermentation with wild yeast and commercial yeast, however, it was too hard to collect data with the current equipment that I had for wild yeast. Consequently, I started reading a series of blogs from "Danny's wine" where he clearly explained better the wine fermentation process and helped me focus and find the final question. I made the fermenter by myself as it was hard to find a small fermenter in the stores for my purposes. I had a hard time finding the non-Saccharomyces (Brettanomyces) because it's not a common yeast used in the primary fermentation. I found some on-line shops selling Brettanomyces however they were all liquid and the Saccharomyces cerevisae I used was in powder and therefore a solid. This would have made my results inaccurate because they were in different states. Therefore, I decided to use another yeast which is the Saccharomyces bayanus,which is a yeast usually used in the primary fermentation mixed with other yeasts. I had also many discussions with the lab assistant regarding the safety and the materials. The hardest part was to monitor all the controlled variables as the temperature was changing quickly.
During the writing process of the extended essay, I discovered that fermentation does not only produce alcohol and there are also other substances like glycerol, acids and tannins that affect the quality of wine. For the methodology, I would have done differently the creation of the fermenter because it would have given me the possibility of measure the alcohol production during each stage of fermentation. The most valuable part of my EE was the process of writing it and especially learning the different types of statistical analysis. I would like to discover more about the other products of fermentation which is also why I decided to continue my research on tannin on my Chemistry IA.

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